

***Technical
Writing***



Technical Writing

Lecture (5)

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Records

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Definition:

- ❑ Records the **memory** of the internal and external of **transaction** of an organization.
- ❑ Records **contain** a written evidence of the **activities** of an organization in the form of letters, circulars, reports, contract, invoice, vouchers, minutes of meeting, books of account, etc.
- ❑ It is a **written** communication that **permanently** documents **information** relevant to a client's health care management.
- ❑ It is a **continuing** account of the client's health care needs..

Principles of Maintaining Records

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- ❑ **Specific** purpose which should be **clearly** understood.
- ❑ Items on forms and in register should be **conveniently** grouped to make their **completion** as easy as possible.
- ❑ The wording should be **easily** understood, and where **doubt** is likely to **arise**, instructions to **facilitates** interpretation should be **included**.
- ❑ Records should **permit** some **freedom** of expression.
- ❑ Records which are **required** by the staff should be **easily** accessible to them.
- ❑ **Provision** for periodic review of all records to **ensure** that they keep pace with the **changing** needs of the program..

Principles of Maintaining Records

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- ❑ Person **responsible** for maintaining records should be **aware** of their particular responsibility and every **effort** should be made to keep records up to date and accurate.
- ❑ **Adequate** supply of **stationary** to permit records to be maintained on the proper forms and in the proper register at **all times**.
- ❑ Sufficient number of **filling** cabinets and appropriate equipment to operate a filling system which is simple and safe and requires the **minimum** possible time.
- ❑ Adequate, safe, fireproof strong **arrangements**..

Characteristics of Good Recording and Reporting

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- ☐ Accurate.
- ☐ Conscious.
- ☐ Thorough.
- ☐ Up to date.
- ☐ Organized.
- ☐ Confidential.
- ☐ Objective..

Purpose of Keeping Records

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- ☐ Communication.
- ☐ Aids to diagnosis.
- ☐ Education.
- ☐ Documentation of continuity.
- ☐ Research.
- ☐ Legal documentation.
- ☐ Individual case study..

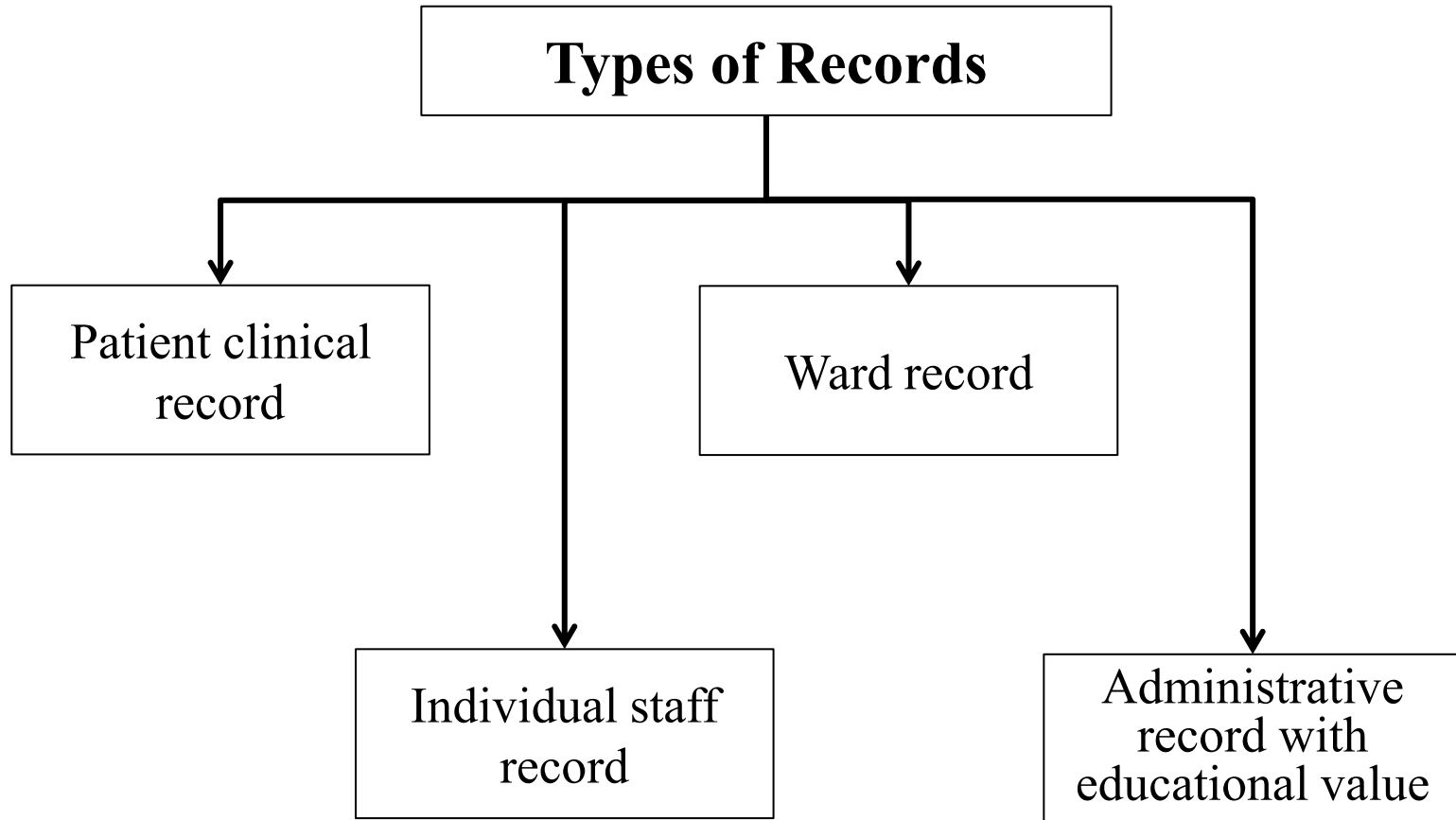
Uses of Records

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- ☐ Show the health conditions **as it is** and as the patient and family **accepts it**.
- ☐ Goals towards which means are to be **directed**.
- ☐ **Prevents** duplication of services and **helps** follow up services effectively.
- ☐ **Helps** the nurses to **evaluate** the care and the teaching.
- ☐ **Organization** of work.
- ☐ Serves as a **guide** for diagnosis treatment and **evaluation** of services.
- ☐ **Indicate** progress.
- ☐ **Used** in research.
- ☐ The health **assets** and **needs** of the village area..

Types of Records

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Patient Clinical Records

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Aim to **know**:

- ✓ **events** in the patient illness,
- ✓ **progress** in his/her recovery and
- ✓ the **type** of care given by the hospital personnel.

And that:

- ☐ In **Scientific** and **legal** method.
- ☐ By providing the patient **evidence** that his/her case is being intelligently managed.
- ☐ By **Avoiding** duplication of work.
- ☐ By providing **Information** for medical and legal nursing.
- ☐ Help **promote** of health and social responsibility.
- ☐ Legal **protection** to the hospital, physician and the nursing..

Patient Clinical Records

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Nursing administrator's responsibility Regarding Clinical Records:

- ✓ **Protection** from loss.
- ✓ **Safeguarding** its contents.
- ✓ **Completeness**.
- ✓ **Follow up** nursing notes.
- ✓ **Conformity** to the legal value of nursing notes.
- ✓ **Traking** admission record.
- ✓ **Matching** the scientific value of the nurse's observations.
- ✓ **Record** of order carried out..

Individual Staff Records

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A separate staff record is required, **recording** details of:

- ❖ **sickness** and **absence**.
- ❖ Their **carrier** and **development** activity.
- ❖ A **personal** note..

Ward Records

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It is required to **recording** details of:

- ❖ **Reduction** and **increase** in beds.
- ❖ **Change** in medical staff and non nursing personnel for the ward.
- ❖ The **introduction** and **pattern** of support.

Administrative Records with Educational Value

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It contains:

- ❖ **Treatments.**
- ❖ **Admissions.**
- ❖ Equipments **losses** and **replacements.**
- ❖ Personnel **performance.**
- ❖ **Other** administrative records..

Filling & Arranging of Record

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It arranged:

- ❖ Alphabetically.
- ❖ Numerically.
- ❖ Geographically.
- ❖ With index cards..

Alphabetical Order

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Alphabetical order is **primarily** used for organizing reference lists and filing patient records, **not** for the main body of a clinical note.

The **principles** of good technical nursing writing **emphasize** clarity, accuracy, and standardized formats like SOAPIE or DAR..

Advantages of alphabetical order:

- ❖ Most people are **familiar**.
- ❖ Staff be able to learn and become **comfortable** with the system in a timely manner.
- ❖ **Repetitive** references can be **avoided**..

Numerically Order

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- ❖ Numerically ordering records means **arranging** them in a **sequence** based on their numbers.
- ❖ Either in **ascending order** (lowest to highest) or **descending order** (highest to lowest).
- ❖ This process, called **sorting**, makes data **more** accessible and readable.
- ❖ Common systems for numeric ordering include
 - ✓ **Straight numeric filing** (sequential order) and
 - ✓ **Terminal-digit filing** (organizing by the last digits of a number).

Geographically Order

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- ❖ Information is **arranged** alphabetically by geographically of **place name**.
- ❖ geographical ordering is a **filing system** that **arranges** records by **location**, grouping all documents related to a specific **geographic area**.
- ❖ The specific method can **range** from **simple** alphabetical lists of places to **complex**, multi-layered hierarchies.
- ❖ This method is especially **useful** for organizations with operations **spread** across multiple locations.

With Index Card Order

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- ❖ An Index Card **consists** of heavy paper cut to a standard size, **used** for recording and storing **small** amount of discrete data.
- ❖ **In addition**, each organization should maintain:
 - ✓ Cumulative records.
 - ✓ Family records..

Guidelines for Documentation and Record Keeping

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Patient records should be:

- ❖ **Based** on fact, correct and consistent.
- ❖ Written as soon as possible after an **event** has happened.
- ❖ Written **clearly** and in such a way that the text **cannot** be erased.
- ❖ Written in such way that any **alternations or additions** are dates, timed and signed, so that the original entry is still clear.
- ❖ **Accurately** dated, timed and signed.
- ❖ **Not include** abbreviations, jargon meaningless phrase, irrelevant speculation and offensive subjective statements.
- ❖ **Readable** on any photocopies..